

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three staves in 2/2 time. Each staff begins with a guitar chord diagram: Dm (first staff), Gm (second staff), and Dm (third staff). The diagrams show fingerings 2, 3, 1. The melody is written in treble clef with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The first staff contains the first line of the melody, the second staff the second line, and the third staff the third line. The lyrics are written below the staves, with two parts of the melody indicated by '1' and '2' at the beginning of each line. The first line of lyrics is '1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.' and '2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.' The second line of lyrics is 'Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.' and 'E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.' The third line of lyrics is 'Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!' and 'Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.' The score ends with a double bar line.

Dm Gm Dm

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

Dm Gm Dm

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

Dm Gm Dm

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.